A post by Bryan Driskell

By Bryan Driskell · @CoachD178 · October 29, 2026

Mr. Pickles Lanman's TLDR:

Mostly holds up

- Bryan Driskell says he counted 33 low shotgun snaps from Notre Dame center Ashton Craig over the team's last two games, and 31 of them came on pass plays.
- He argues that low snaps are a serious problem because they throw off the quarterback's timing and his read of the defense.
- He contrasts this with coach Marcus Freeman, who played the issue down and praised Craig's play.

TRUTH CHECK The 33-snap count is Driskell's own film tally, and no official stat tracks it. An independent reporter separately counted at least 18 such snaps against BYU, which backs up the general problem. Reports confirm that Freeman was asked about the low snaps, but I could not open a transcript that has his exact quoted words.

Serif text is the author's, unchanged. Underlines and numbers point to Pickles' margin notes.

Per my count, Notre Dame has had 33 low snaps the last two games[1]. 31 of them on pass plays. That's AWFUL, and it's easy to identify why he's doing it[2]. That is absolutely, 100% a major issue. Anyone that plays QB will tell you a low snap is a major, major problem when reading a defense[3] and playing with timing

> *Quoting @PeteSampson_: Marcus Freeman asked about Ashton Craig's low snaps at BYU.[4] Didn't sound much of an alarm[5], thought the offense handled the operation. "Ashton's continuing to play at a high level, continuing to practice at a high level."*

1 · TRUTH CHECK: UNVERIFIED
A personal count, partly backed up
No official stat tracks low snaps, so 33 is Driskell's own film count. Sports Illustrated's Notre Dame writer separately counted at least 18 low snaps in the BYU game alone, so the problem is real. Because of the Oct. 24 bye, the 'last two games' are Stanford (a 58-7 win) and BYU (a 28-24 loss).
Notre Dame On SI, BYU takeaways · Yahoo Sports, ND schedule

2 · PICKLES' TAKE
The 'why' never comes
He says the cause is easy to see, then never tells us what it is. The 31 of 33 split on pass plays suggests something about the shotgun pass setup, but readers are left to guess. Without the cause, they can't judge whether this is easy to fix or a deeper flaw.

3 · PICKLES' TAKE
Sound point, but no damage shown
The logic holds. A quarterback who has to dip for the ball takes his eyes off the defense and loses rhythm. But he shows no link to actual results like sacks, turnovers or failed drives. Notre Dame scored 58 against Stanford and lost to BYU on the final play, so the scoreboard alone doesn't show how much it cost.

4 · TRUTH CHECK: CONFIRMED
Freeman did address it
An On3 article from Navy week lists Craig's low-snap struggles at BYU among Freeman's Thursday press takeaways. I could not open the full article or an official transcript, so the exact wording of the quote is unverified.
On3 (search summary; full article blocked)

5 · PICKLES' TAKE

Coaches rarely criticize players in public

Head coaches almost never criticize a starting player in front of reporters, especially a veteran center returning from two season-ending knee injuries. Freeman's calm answer doesn't show that the staff ignores the problem, so the contrast with Driskell is weaker than it looks. Notre Dame did beat Navy 35-13 after this post, though I didn't check whether the snaps improved.

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